TFSA + RRSP Multi-Brokerage Tracker: User Guide

Every tab, every column and every menu item, in plain English

The tracker is built around one idea: you type each transaction once, in the Transaction Log, and every other tab updates by itself. The only other place you type is the amber cells on Settings & Goals. Everything green is a formula: leave it alone and it will always be right.

Colour	Meaning
Amber	Your input. Type here (Settings & Goals).
Blue	A dropdown. Pick from the list (Institution, Account, Type, Currency).
White	Manual entry in the Transaction Log (date, ticker, shares, price, amount).
Green	A formula. Do not type here.
Navy / Green / Purple	TFSA / RRSP / both accounts combined, on every tab.

Your template link: https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1EmXyqjuF6TiqGtgq8v4Qclw7G5Fei42SmEmYM8k3OJg/copy (opens Make a copy).

THE MAPLESHEET MENU

Menu item	What it does
Build / Rebuild All Tabs	Builds every tab. Safe to run again: it keeps your Settings inputs and Transaction Log rows.
Load Sample Data	Fills the Transaction Log with a sample investor: TFSAs at Wealthsimple and Questrade, RRSPs at Questrade, RBC and TD. Replaces anything in the log.
Clear Sample Data	Empties the Transaction Log. Formulas, dropdowns and Settings stay.
Rebuild Dashboard Charts	Redraws the charts if one goes blank.
About	Shows the version.

First time you use the menu. Google shows an "Authorization required" box. Click Continue, choose your Google account, then Advanced and Allow. The script only works inside your own copy of the sheet.

1. SETTINGS & GOALS: SET UP ONCE, UPDATE EACH JANUARY

Cell	What to enter	Notes
B5 to B8	Your name, province, Active Year and birth year.	Change B7 every January. B9 (RRIF year) is automatic.
B13 to B20	Up to 8 institutions where you have a TFSA, an RRSP or both. Leave a slot blank to hide it.	Use exactly the same name every time.
B23	TFSA annual limit for the Active Year.	$7,000 for 2026.
B24	Your TFSA contribution room on January 1, from CRA My Account.	ONE number for all your TFSAs.
B31	"RRSP deduction limit" from your latest Notice of Assessment.	Already includes carry-forward room.
B32	"Unused RRSP contributions" from the same NOA (often $0).	B33 = B31 – B32 is your available RRSP room.

Cell	What to enter	Notes
B34	The $2,000 lifetime over-contribution buffer.	Leave it unless CRA changes it.
B43 to B46	TFSA goal, RRSP goal, dividend goal and net worth goal.	Your own plan.
B49 to B50	Default currency and an optional USD/CAD rate.	Leave B50 blank to use the live rate.

The grey cells are a quick reference for both accounts (deadlines, withholding, the treaty, the Home Buyers' Plan). At the bottom are two checklists, one for December and one for January.

2. TRANSACTION LOG: THE ONLY TAB YOU TYPE INTO

One row per transaction, starting on row 4. Never delete old rows: your ACB and room numbers depend on the full history. **Already own investments?** Log each holding once as a Buy, with column L = what you paid for it, and log this year's contributions so far.

Col	Column	What to enter
A	Date	The trade or deposit date (yyyy-mm-dd).
B	Year	Automatic.
C	Institution	Dropdown from Settings B13:B20.
D	Account	**TFSA or RRSP. Pick it on every row.** It decides which portfolio and which room the row counts in.
E	Type	Dropdown, see the table below.
F	Ticker	Canadian: with the prefix (TSE:XEQT, TSE:RY). US: with or without (KO or NYSE:KO). Blank for contributions.
G	Description	Anything that helps you remember.
H	Currency	CAD or USD. This (not the ticker) decides whether prices are converted to CAD.
I	Shares / Units	For Buy, Sell, DRIP and transfers of shares.
J	Price / Share	For Buy, Sell and DRIP.
K	Commission	Optional.
L	Amt (Original)	The total in the original currency (for a Buy: shares × price + commission).
M	FX Rate	Automatic: 1 for CAD, live USD/CAD (or your override) for USD.
N	Amt (CAD)	Automatic. Every dashboard adds up this column.
O	Check	Automatic. Shows ✓, or what is missing (institution, account, ticker, shares, amount).

Type	Use it for
Contribution	Money you put into a TFSA or RRSP. This is what uses room.
Withdrawal	Money you take out. TFSA: comes back as room on January 1 next year. RRSP: taxed, room never comes back.
Buy / Sell	Shares, price and commission, plus the total in column L.
Dividend	Cash dividend: log what arrived in the account (in a TFSA, US dividends arrive after 15% US tax).
DRIP	A dividend reinvested in new shares: enter the shares, the price and the amount.
Fee	Account or admin fees.

Type	Use it for
Transfer Out / Transfer In	A direct transfer between two of YOUR accounts of the same type at two institutions. Log both sides. With a ticker and shares, it moves shares. It is not a contribution and uses no room.

3. MAIN DASHBOARD

Section	What it shows
3 big cards	TFSA market value, RRSP market value and combined net worth, each with the gain vs cost.
Institution cards	One column per brokerage plus All Institutions: TFSA value, RRSP value, total, gain/loss, TFSA contributions this year, RRSP contributions in the room window and dividends this year.
TFSA room	Annual limit, room on January 1, contributed this year, room left, withdrawn this year, and the room you will have on January 1 next year (before the new limit). The message line warns you before CRA does.
RRSP room	Deduction limit, unused contributions, available room, contributed from March 2 to March 1, room left and withdrawals. Over-contributions within the $2,000 lifetime buffer get a softer warning.
Right column	Last 5 transactions, income this year (TFSA, RRSP, average, full-year estimate) and progress bars for your TFSA, RRSP and net worth goals.
Charts	Market value by institution (TFSA and RRSP stacked), and monthly dividend income.

Why the RRSP uses March 2 to March 1. Contributions made in the first 60 days of a year can be deducted on the previous year's return, so CRA's room for 2026 covers March 2, 2026 to March 1, 2027. A contribution in January or February 2026 is counted against your 2025 limit and does not appear in the 2026 room block.

4. TFSA PORTFOLIO AND RRSP PORTFOLIO

Every stock and ETF in that account, all institutions combined: currency (detected from your Transaction Log), shares, average cost in CAD, cost basis, live price in CAD, market value, gain/loss, return % and all-time dividends. Shares = buys + DRIP + transfers in – sells – transfers out.

5. INSTITUTION DASHBOARD

Up to 8 brokerages side by side: TFSA and RRSP market value and cost, total value, gain/loss, contributions to each account and dividends, with both room blocks underneath. On the right, a donut chart and table show what share of your TFSA + RRSP money is at each brokerage.

6. DIVIDEND TRACKER

Eight cards (all-time income, TFSA and RRSP income this year, DRIP, monthly average, full-year estimate, goal and progress), a US withholding estimate, Section A month by month (TFSA and RRSP) against your monthly target, Section B every dividend and DRIP with its institution and account, and Section C a per-ticker summary with an annual run rate.

US withholding estimate. TFSA: the IRS keeps 15% of US dividends and you cannot get it back; the tracker estimates it from the USD dividends you logged (received × 15/85). RRSP: US-listed dividends arrive in full thanks to the Canada-US treaty; the tracker shows the 15% you saved. Canadian-listed ETFs that hold US stocks lose 15% inside the fund in both.

7. TFSA & RRSP CRA RULES

The rules that matter when you hold both accounts at more than one institution, as colour-coded cards: red for costly mistakes, amber for limits and deadlines, green for benefits. The Government Rules PDF explains each one in more detail.

EVERY JANUARY

1. **Make a copy (optional)**
   File, Make a copy, named for the new year. Or keep one file: the log holds all history.
2. **Change the Active Year**
   Settings B7, for example 2026 to 2027. All "this year" numbers switch to the new year.
3. **Update your TFSA room**
   B23 (the new annual limit) and B24 (your room on January 1, from CRA My Account).
4. **Update your RRSP numbers**
   B31 and B32 from your new Notice of Assessment, usually in the spring after you file.
5. **Keep logging**
   Add new transactions below the old ones. Holdings and ACB carry forward automatically.

TROUBLESHOOTING

Problem	Fix
A price shows $0.00	Canadian tickers need TSE: (TSE:XEQT). NEO: for Cboe Canada. GOOGLEFINANCE can also pause for a few minutes.
A US stock's value looks too low	Its Buy rows must have Currency = USD so the price is converted to CAD.
A transaction is missing from a dashboard	Look at column O. The Institution must match Settings exactly, the Account and Type must be picked, and the date must be a real date.
TFSA room looks wrong	B24 must be your room on January 1 of the Active Year. Withdrawals made this year only come back next year.
RRSP room looks wrong	B31 is the NOA deduction limit (do not add carry-forward). January and February contributions count for last year.
"This year" numbers are $0	Settings B7 (Active Year) does not match the year of your transactions.
A chart is blank	MapleSheet menu, Rebuild Dashboard Charts.
Something broke	MapleSheet menu, Build / Rebuild All Tabs. Your inputs and transactions are kept.

For educational purposes only. Not financial or tax advice. Rules summarized for 2026 from canada.ca. Always confirm your own room in CRA My Account. Questions: hello@maplesheet.ca